

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 7 6 4

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 2

♣ A 8 4 3

♠ 5 3

♥ K 8 6 5

♦ A Q J 10 6 4

♣ K



♠ A 9

♥ A Q 9 3

♦ K 8 7 5

♣ J 6 5

♠ K J 10 8 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 3

♣ Q 10 9 7 2

The bidding has been as shown. It is your turn.

You have 14 points but so what. You have no 5-card suit to Overcall. You cannot make a Takeout Double with 4 of their suit. So you pass. It is important to realize that there are hands you would open but cannot overcall with.

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

All Pass

1♦ by North

Lead: ♣5

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 8 6 4
♥ 4
♦ 10 5
♣ K 10 9 4 2

♠ A 7 5 3
♥ K 10 9 3
♦ K 9 6 4
♣ 5



♠ K
♥ 8 6 2
♦ A 8 3 2
♣ A Q J 7 3

♠ 10 9 2
♥ A Q J 7 5
♦ Q J 7
♣ 8 6

The bidding has been as shown.

With four trumps and 12 points you have a text-book raise to 3♥. Partner had a minimum overcall though, so he passed.

West	North	East	South
		1♣	1♥
Pass	3♥		
All Pass			
3♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ 10			

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J
♥ 9 2
♦ K Q J 4
♣ A K Q 10 2

♠ 10 9
♥ A Q J 7 5
♦ A 8 7 5
♣ 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 6 5 2
♥ 10 6 4
♦ 10 9 2
♣ J 7

♠ A 7 4 3
♥ K 8 3
♦ 6 3
♣ 9 8 4 3

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
All Pass			
2 ♥ by North			
Lead: ♣J			

The bidding has been as shown.

With 12 points and a good suit you have a very solid overcall so you bid 1 ♥. Partner responds 2 ♥.

Partner is showing 6-10 points and three trumps. Your hand revalues to 14 at most so you pass.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 8 5 4 3 2

♥ Q 7 6

♦ J 3

♣ J 10

♠ 6

♥ K J 9 4 3

♦ K 9 4

♣ 8 7 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A

♥ A 10 5 2

♦ A 10 8 7 5

♣ A K 2

♠ K Q J 9 7

♥ 8

♦ Q 6 2

♣ Q 9 4 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♦

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by South

Lead: ♦ J

The bidding has been as shown.

You really don't like partner's ♠s, and you do have 8 points. But 8 points is not enough to be considering game, and you would have to bid your ♥s at the 2-level. All things considered it is better to pass while you still aren't doubled.

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 8 6 4
♥ 10 9
♦ 5
♣ A J 8 4 2

♠ 10 9

♥ K Q J 7 5 2

♦ Q J 7

♣ 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 3

♥ 4

♦ K 9 8 6 4 3

♣ K Q 9 7

♠ J 7 5 2

♥ A 8 6 3

♦ A 10 2

♣ 10 3

West

1 ♠

All Pass

3 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣K

North

2 ♥

East

Pass

South

3 ♥

The bidding has been as shown.

You overcall 2 ♥ and hear partner raise you to 3 ♥.

No matter how many times you check this hand you cannot revalue it any more than 13 points. Since partner has 10 at the most you reluctantly pass.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 4
 ♥ Q 6 5
 ♦ K J 6 2
 ♣ J 6 5 4

♠ J 8 3

♥ A J 9 2

♦ 10 7

♣ 9 8 3 2



♠ Q 6 2

♥ 8 7 4

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ A Q 10

♠ A K 9 7 5

♥ K 10 3

♦ 9 5 3

♣ K 7

*West**North**East**South*

2♦

2♠

1♦

1♠

All Pass

2♠ by South

Lead: ♠10

The bidding has been as shown.

With only 7 points you might not think you have enough to make a "free bid". But in competitive bidding situations like these, where both sides have a fit, bidding is usually better than passing. So you bid 2♠.

You might look at the Law of Total Tricks lesson for more on this subject.

Board 7

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 7
♥ J 8 5
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 10 7 5 4

♠ Q J 10 9 3

♥ K Q 4

♦ 8 6 3

♣ 8 2



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 7 6 2

♦ K J 9 2

♣ A J 6

♠ K 8 4 2

♥ A 9 3

♦ 10 5

♣ K Q 9 3

West

1 ♦

North

1 ♠

East

Pass

South

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ 6

The bidding has been as shown.

You have enough for a 1-level Overcall so you bid 1 ♠. Partner says 3 ♠.

The jump raise tells you partner has 11-14 points.

With your minimum it's going to have to be better than that to get you excited. So you pass.

Board 8

East Deals

None Vul

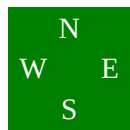
♠ 9 2
♥ J 10 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7 4
♣ 10 6

♠ K 8 7 5 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A

♣ 7 5 4 3



♠ 10
♥ A K Q 9 8
♦ J 5 3
♣ A K Q 9

♠ A Q J 6 4

♥ 3

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ J 8 2

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

4♠

1♥

1♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

Lead: ♥J

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 10 points, but in cases like this points don't matter that much. They **MIGHT** be able to make 4♥. Partner **MIGHT** be able to make 4♠. This preemptive jump takes the decision away from them.

Looking at the hands you can see that partner is going to go down 1 at 4♠. However, that is an excellent result since they appear to be cold for 5♥.

Board 9

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 10 4
♥ 5
♦ Q 10 9
♣ K J 10 7 6

♠ 5 3

♥ A K 10 8 4

♦ K 6 3

♣ A 5 4



♠ 9 8 2

♥ J 6 2

♦ J 8 7 2

♣ Q 8 3

♠ A J 7 6

♥ Q 9 7 3

♦ A 5 4

♣ 9 2

West

1 ♣

Pass

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣ 3

North

1 ♥

4 ♥

East

Pass

South

3 ♥

The bidding has been as shown.

Nice hand. But not nice enough to double, then bid your ♥s. So you overcall 1 ♥. Partner says 3 ♥.

The jump raise promises 11-14 points. Your 17 plus partner's 11 or so takes you right up to game. You bid 4 ♥.

Board 10

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 8 6 3
♥ A 7 6 4
♦ K Q
♣ 10 6

♠ 7 2

♥ Q 8

♦ J 5 2

♣ A K J 9 7 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 4

♥ J 9 3

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 8 5 4

♠ A K 5

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ 10 9 7 4

♣ Q 3

West

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♦ K

North

2 ♣

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has at least 11 points for his 2-level overcall. He might have as many as 16. You have a perfect invitational hand including two sure stoppers in their suit. So you bid 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT and you get to play it there.

Board 11

West Deals

None Vul

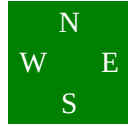
♠ J 6 4
 ♥ Q 9 5
 ♦ K Q
 ♣ A J 5 4 2

♠ K Q 9

♥ A 8 4

♦ A 10 5

♣ K Q 9 3



♠ 10 7 5

♥ 7 3 2

♦ 8 7 6 4 2

♣ 7 6

♠ A 8 3 2

♥ K J 10 6

♦ J 9 3

♣ 10 8

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	1NT	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠ 7			

The bidding has been as shown.

This hand would be one point too strong to **Open** 1NT, but it fits the 15-18 range to **Overcall** 1NT. Partner responds 2 ♣.

Don't get your systems crossed. Partner did not make a cue-bid, he is using Stayman. Since you have no 4-card Major suit you answer 2 ♦. Partner now says 2NT and the ball is in your court.

This is just a plain old 1NT/Stayman sequence. Partner is inviting, and since you have 18 points you accept.

Board 12

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 4
♥ 10 9 4 3
♦ Q J 4 3
♣ J 7 4 2

♠ Q 8 6 3
♥ A K Q 7
♦ 6 5
♣ K 10 6



♠ J 9 2
♥ 8 5 2
♦ A K 10 8
♣ A 9 5

♠ A K 10 7 5
♥ J 6
♦ 9 7 2
♣ Q 8 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ Q			

The bidding has been as shown.

Wow! Great ♠ support and 15 points. You cue-bid 2 ♦, forcing partner to bid. He says 2 ♠. Your turn.

Partner has not made a strong bid and it is possible that 10 tricks will be too high. But it is pretty likely that game can be made so you bid it. Be bold!

Board 13

West Deals

Both Vul

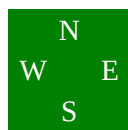
♠ 5
♥ A J 10 9 7 3
♦ J 9
♣ A Q J 10

♠ K Q J 9 8 4

♥ 8 4

♦ Q 6 3

♣ 9 5



♠ A 6 3 2
♥ 5
♦ A 10 7 4 2
♣ K 6 3

♠ 10 7

♥ K Q 6 2

♦ K 8 5

♣ 8 7 4 2

West

1 ♥

All Pass

2 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ 5

North

2 ♠

*East**South*

The bidding has been as shown.

If you had been the dealer you would have opened 2 ♠. The situation is no different after they open so you Overcall 2 ♠. Everybody passes.

Board 14

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10
 ♥ 5 4 2
 ♦ K Q 7 4 2
 ♣ A 9 4

♠ 9 7 5

♥ K Q J 9 7

♦ 8 3

♣ K 5 2



♠ 4 2

♥ A 10 8 6

♦ A J 10 9

♣ J 8 3

♠ A K J 8 6 3

♥ 3

♦ 6 5

♣ Q 10 7 6

West

1 ♦

Pass

All Pass

2 ♠ by South

Lead: ♦ K

North

1 ♥

2 ♠

East

Pass

South

1 ♠

The bidding has been as shown.

You don't like to take partner out of his overcalled suit without good reason. Here you have good reason. So you bid 1 ♠. Partner replies 2 ♠. What do you say next?

You expect partner to have three trumps, but he has made a minimum bid. So you take the conservative route and pass.

Board 15

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 4
 ♥ 9 6 5 3
 ♦ Q 10 9 4
 ♣ K 8 2

♠ K Q J 9 7 3

♥ Q

♦ A 8 7 2

♣ 10 4



♠ A 2

♥ 10 7 2

♦ J 5

♣ A Q J 7 6 3

♠ 10 8 5

♥ A K J 8 4

♦ K 6 3

♣ 9 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♣	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♦ J			

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a nice easy decision here. You overcall 1 ♥. Then partner bids 1 ♠. What do you say next?

Whether you play a change of suit as forcing or not, your hand certainly qualifies as one where you should make a bid. Partner doesn't really like your ♥s but you are quite satisfied to play in ♠s. So you bid 2 ♠. Partner jumps to 4 ♠ and that closes out the auction.

Board 16

East Deals

E-W Vul

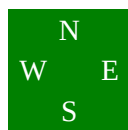
♠ 6 2
 ♥ 9 4 2
 ♦ 9 7 4 3
 ♣ K J 8 3

♠ K Q 8 3

♥ A 8 6 5

♦ 6 5

♣ 10 7 6



♠ A 7 5 4

♥ Q J

♦ K Q 8 2

♣ 9 4 2

♠ J 10 9

♥ K 10 7 3

♦ A J 10

♣ A Q 5

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	1NT
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♥		
All Pass			
3 ♥ by South			
Lead: ♠ 6			

The bidding has been as shown.

You treat partner's 1NT Overcall the same as a 1NT Opening. You use Stayman and bid 2 ♣. Partner replies 2 ♥. What is your next bid?

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand. You bid 3 ♥, inviting partner to go to game with a maximum. He declines your invitation.

Board 17

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K 7 5 3 2

♥ A 2

♦ J 6 2

♣ A 8 4

♠ A J 9

♥ 10 9 4

♦ K 3

♣ Q J 10 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 6

♥ 8 7 6 5 3

♦ 10 8 7 4

♣ 5

♠ 8 4

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q 9 5

♣ K 9 7 2

West

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 10

North

2 ♣

2NT

East

Pass

Pass

South

2 ♠

3NT

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a sound 2-level overcall. You bid 2 ♣ and partner replies 2 ♠. What is your next bid?

Partner's cue-bid obviously forces you to bid.

Partner's hand might be very distributional, but rather than just sticking to ♣s you suggest with 2NT. This guarantees you have ♠s stopped. Partner likes your suggestion and bids 3NT.

Board 18

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 6 3
♦ 10 5 4
♣ A K 9 3

♠ K Q J 10 5

♥ Q 10 7

♦ A J 3

♣ 8 7



♠ 9 4 2
♥ 8 5 4 2
♦ 8 6 2
♣ 5 4 2

♠ 8 3

♥ A J 9

♦ K Q 9 7

♣ Q J 10 6

The bidding has been as shown.

Balanced hand, poor support for partner's suit, stoppers in their suit and 13 points. You couldn't get a better hand to jump to 2NT. Partner takes you to 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1 ♣	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 19

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 4 2

♥ J 4 3

♦ J 8 2

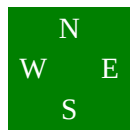
♣ 6 4

♠ A J 10

♥ Q 10 7

♦ A 7 5

♣ K Q 10 9



♠ K 6 5

♥ A 9 6 2

♦ 3

♣ A J 8 5 3

♠ 8 3

♥ K 8 5

♦ K Q 10 9 6 4

♣ 7 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2NT

1♣

2♦

Pass

3NT

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♣5

The bidding has been as shown.

With a good 6-card suit and 10 points you make a Weak Jump Overcall to 2♦. Partner says 2NT.

The 2NT bid is a standard response to a Weak 2-bid. It asks for the identification of any outside high-card if the Weak 2-bidder has more than a minimum. Here you are in the top range for your bid so you show your ♥K.

That was apparently the missing link for partner, he now says 3NT.

Board 20

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 4
 ♥ J 10 9 6 3
 ♦ Q 10 8 4
 ♣ Q 7

♠ A 8 5
 ♥ A K 7
 ♦ K J 6
 ♣ 10 8 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 7
 ♥ Q 5
 ♦ 9 5 3 2
 ♣ A K J 5 3

♠ K Q 10 9 3 2
 ♥ 8 4 2
 ♦ A 7
 ♣ 9 2

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	2 ♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3 ♦
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ J			

The bidding has been as shown.

You might just try 4 ♠. Of course if partner has a minimum Weak Jump Overcall that will get you much too high. A better approach is to ask for more information from partner. The bid that asks is 2NT. Partner replies 3 ♦.

Partner's 3 ♦ bid tells you two things. One, he is in the top half of his 6-11 point range. Two, he has a high card (Ace or King) in ♦s. When you construct a hand for him which contains 6 pretty good ♠s and the ♦ A you come up with a hand which will probably make game. Bid 4 ♠.